

# Gammon Bomb (Hand Grenade No. 82)

PAGES FROM THE ORIGINAL MANUAL

TM 9-1985-1, British Explosive Ordnance (Department of the Army, 1952)

WHAT'S INSIDE

The British No. 82 “Gammon” grenade: data, the cut-away drawing and how it was primed and thrown.

3 pages from the original follow: the manual's cover, then the section about this weapon. Original US Government publication (public domain). Scans courtesy of the Internet Archive and Wikimedia Commons.

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# TM9-1985-1

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY TECHNICAL MANUAL

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## BRITISH EXPLOSIVE ORDNANCE

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DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY • JULY 1952

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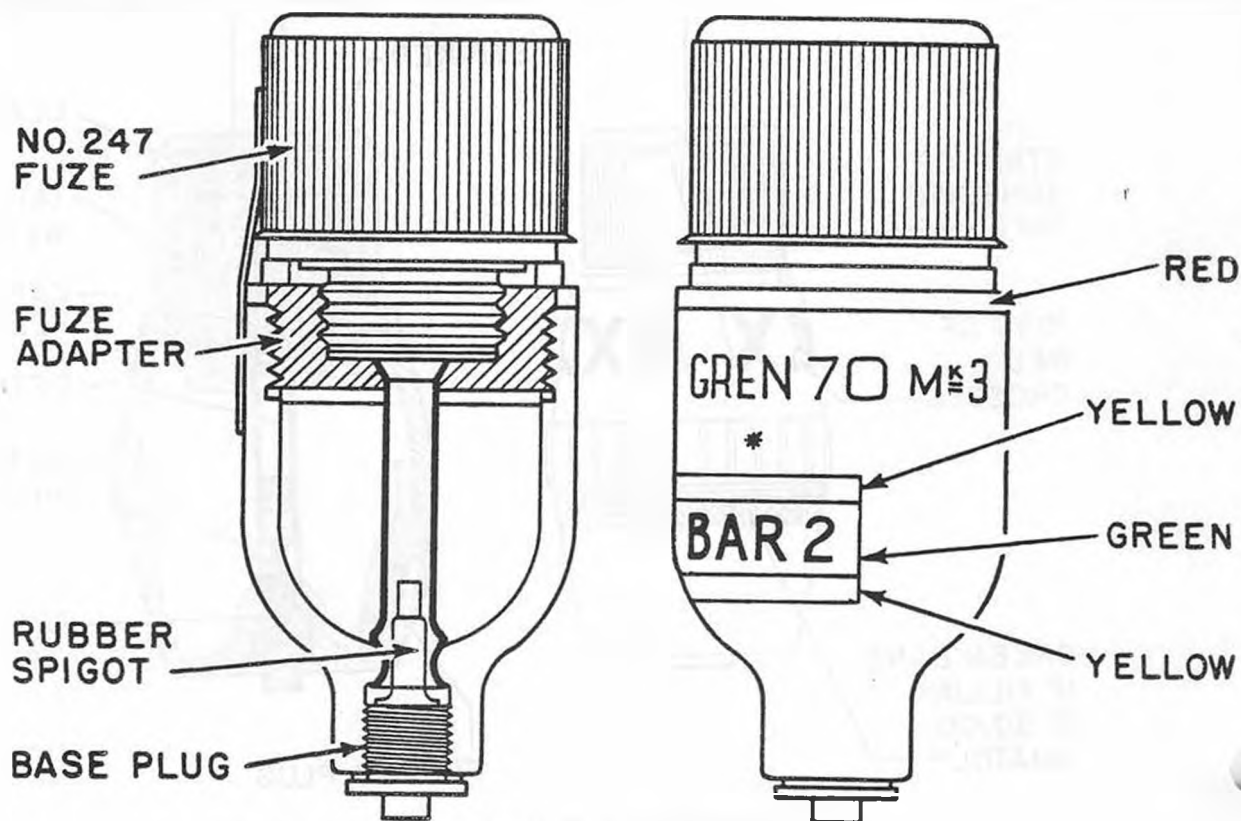


Figure 234—A./P. Hand Grenade No. 70 Mk III

**Operation:** The adhesive tape securing the fuze safety cap and the cap itself are removed. When the grenade is thrown, a weighted strip of tape withdraws the safety pin to arm the fuze. On impact, the striker overcomes the creep spring, and fires the cap, which initiates the detonator and, in turn, the main filling.

**Remarks:** The Grenade No. 70 Mk I was allocated to a small number of experimental designs not issued for service use.

The Hand Grenade No. 71 was a larger grenade of the same type construction as the No. 70, weighing approximately two pounds. The Grenade No. 71 was never adopted for service use.

#### A./P. Hand Grenade No. 82 Mk I (Service)

##### Data

Total weight ..... 2 lb. approx.  
Filling ..... Plastic explosive  
Filling weight ..... 1 lb. approx.  
Fuzing.... No. 247 Mk I, II, or III, with short  
4½ in. tape  
Delay ..... None  
Color..... Fuze, black; cup, buff; bag, black  
Markings ..... Standard

**Description:** The body of this H.E. grenade, formerly known as the "Gammon Bomb," consists of a fabric bag, open at each end. The lower end of the bag is gathered, and an elastic band inserted around the edge, while the upper end fits under a steel cup. The edge is clamped

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**ANTI-PERSONNEL GRENADES**

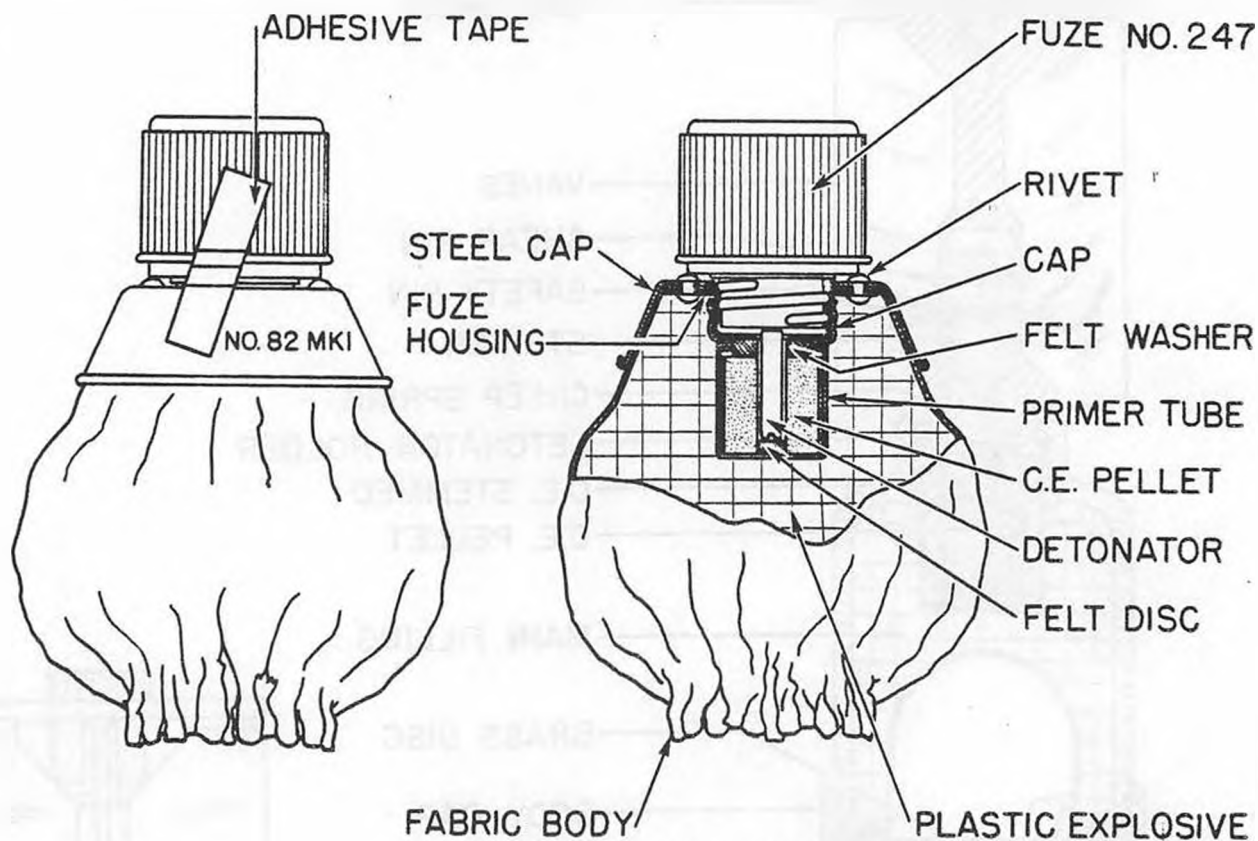


Figure 235—A./P. Hand Grenade No. 82 Mk I

between the cup and the flange of a tinned plate fuze housing by four equally spaced rivets. A tin-plate cap, to the lower end of which is secured an aluminum primer tube, is screwed over the fuze housing.

The grenade is fuzeed with the Fuze No. 247 wound with 4½ in. of tape instead of the usual 12 in. The primer tube contains a C.E. pellet over which is placed a felt washer. A central perforation in the pellet accommodates a Detonator No. 78 Mk I with a felt disc inserted between it and the bottom of the primer tube.

The grenade is issued with the bag empty. The charge of plastic explosive is inserted through the bottom of the bag under local arrangements.

**Operation:** First the grenade is primed and

the plastic explosive inserted. The adhesive tape is then removed and the safety cap unscrewed in one-half of a turn. After the cap is removed, the tape must be held in place by the forefinger and thumb. When thrown, the weight on the end of the tape causes the tape to unwind and pull out the safety pin. Only the creep spring is now holding the striker away from the primer cap. On impact, the striker is forced into the primer cap, igniting the delay, which initiates the detonator and explodes the grenade.

**Remarks:** The No. 82 Mk I/I differs from the No. 82A Mk I in that it has a rot-proof fabric bag.

This grenade has a general anti-personnel application, but is used mainly by airborne forces as an anti-tank weapon.

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